

Twitter blocks third party clients

Twitter suspended third party Twitter clients like UberTwitter, UberCurrent and Twidroid for alleged violation of Twitter policies

Samsung unveils Chat phones

Samsung has come out with two budget dual-SIM QWERTY phones Chat 322 and Chat 335 for the Indian market

Bazaar mini

GAMING KEYBOARD



Razer BlackWidow Ultimate

Price: ₹7,299

PORTABLE SPEAKER



Portronics Zcube - Portable Speaker

Price: ₹1,099

MINI PC



ZOTAC ZBOX AD03BR

Price: ₹26,999



ZOTAC ZBOX HD-ID34

Price: ₹26,999

SPECIFICATIONS

Size in mm 475(L) x 171(W) x 30(H)
Weight 1.5 kg
Additional Macro keys 5
On-the-fly macro recording Yes

Impedance 4 Ohm
Dimensions 120x35x66 mm
Driver Size 70 x 30 mm
Net weight 130 g

Processor AMD E350 @ 1.6GHz
GPU AMD Radeon HD 6310
RAM 2 GB
HDD 250 GB

Processor.. Intel Atom D525 @ 1.8 GHz
GPU NVIDIA ION
RAM 2 GB
HDD 250 GB

TEST CENTRE RATINGS (All Scores out of 10)

Features 7.5

This mechanical keyboard is fully backlit and provides five dedicated macro buttons

Performance 7.0

Good tactile feedback with increased words per minute. Placement of the macro keys was a bit of a problem while going for CTRL or ALT-tabbing.

Build Quality 8.5

Built like a tank. The glossy piano black finish, however is a magnet for dust and grease.

Value for money 6.0

Mechanical keyboards do tend to be more expensive, but at ₹7,299, it is way too expensive.

Features 8.0

It's got FM radio, an SD Card slot for MP3 playback, and a 3.5 mm audio jack for headphones

Performance 6.0

Compared it to a ₹1290 X-mini Capsule, the Zcube's audio quality falls short. It was loud enough but sounded a bit muffled with less bass.

Build quality 6.5

The overall build seems sturdy with a decent finish. Though we wouldn't want to drop-test it.

Value for money 7.0

For the price you get decent performance, with a whole lot of features including an MP3 player.

Features 7.5

It has an AMD E350 dual core APU with a slot loading Blu ray drive and supports USB 3.0.

Performance 7.0

PC Mark Vantage gave 2324 which was higher than 2097 on the Atom D525 based ZBOX. HD movie viewing was quite good and did not stutter.

Build quality 6.5

Built with strong plastic tapering at both ends. Comes with a stand to mount on TV or a wall.

Value for money 5.0

The price of ₹26,999 is a bit on the higher side for a media player and mini PC.

Features 7.5

It houses an Intel D525 dual core CPU with a slot loading Blu ray drive with USB 3.0, eSATA ports

Performance 6.0

PC Mark Vantage gave 2097 which was lower than the AD03 BR. Blu ray playback was flawless and did not stutter. It does tend to heat up under the sides.

Build Quality 6.5

Built with strong plastic tapering at both ends. Comes with a stand to mount on TV or a wall.

Value for money 5.0

The price of ₹26,999 is a bit on the higher side for a media player and mini PC.

WE SAY

7.0

Mechanical keyboards are supposed to give the best tactile feedback in the industry, but if you've spent too much time on membrane-based keyboards, this one might take a little time to get used to. For us it brings back memories of the good old TVS Gold. The driver software is easy to use and great for programming macros. The command stack could include delays and launching programs. There is a gaming mode which disables windows functions. At 1.5 kg it will be a bit difficult to carry around. Good for those seeking exclusivity at a premium.

7.0

If you're willing to put your music on an SD card, you could look at this as an MP3 and FM player built around a portable speaker. Although the device may not exactly be pocketable, it's still quite compact. It has the footprint of a regular full size mouse. It charges its lithium ion battery through a USB cable which is provided. This is a good device for someone looking for all three of the features it provides, but if you want just the functionality of a portable speaker there are better options available out there.

6.5

ZOTAC ZBOX AD03BR makes for a great HTPC, with Blu ray support and HDMI out which allows it to be hooked to your HDTV sets. The AMD Fusion APU did not return impressive computing scores, but is a good answer to Intel's Atom line of processors. Gaming is manageable at resolutions of 800x600 pixels using the AMD HD 6310 graphics solution. Doom 3 (800x600) gave 44 fps while Company of Heroes: Tales of Valor (1024x768, low) gave 52 fps. The AD03BR comes at a price tag of ₹26,999 which is a bit on the higher side.

6.0

ZOTAC ZBOX HD-ID34 makes for a great HTPC, with Blu-ray support and HDMI out which allows it to be hooked to your HDTV sets. It gets a thumbs up for the various connectivity options. As far as computing goes, it is best for casual surfing, basic office work and entry level gaming. USB 3 support does make it future proof. We still felt that the pricing of ₹26,999 was a bit on the higher side, as the computing performance leaves a lot to be desired. It would have been nice if ZOTAC had bundled in a wireless keyboard or a remote controls.